

D

Find out why Facebook uses D to code some of its features.

D is a new programming language that is object-oriented, imperative, multi-paradigm system programming language. It started off as a re-engineered C++ though over the years it has been redesigned quite a bit to incorporate features of modern day programming languages like Java, Python, Ruby and C#. So you have the same performance as C++, is less verbose and is memory safe but it has the expressive power of modern languages as mentioned above.



Work began on D in 1999 when Walter Bright started off with improving C++ which lacked a few paradigms like OOP(object oriented programming) and metaprogramming that were staple of modern programming languages. A functional language was created in 2001. However, in 2005 Walter Bright happened to meet Andrei Alexandrescu who was also working on his own programming language(Enki). Both of their languages had significant upgrades and it seemed as if they were solving each other's problems.

So they started working together and by 2007, D1 or D version 1.0 was born. By this time the language had already been seeded into the community and they had a few modifications of their own to add to the mix. Phobos which was D's official runtime and standard library wasn't well received and the community came up with Tango to replace it.